

KSB ZAMBIA · PURCHASE REQUISITION SYSTEM

User Manual

Role 2 — HOD

Head of Department — first-stage approver for your department

Read first	All Users manual (00-all-users.pdf)
Approval stage	Stage 1 of 3 (for PRs) / Stage 1 of 2 (for EFT, PC, EC, Issue Slips)
Key responsibility	First check on all department spend; 48-hour turnaround target

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1. Who You Are

You are a **Head of Department (HOD)**. You lead a department and are the first formal check on every spending request that originates from your team.

1.1 What you can do

- See every request initiated by someone in your department or by a direct subordinate.
- Approve or reject Purchase Requisitions, EFTs, Petty Cash, Expense Claims, and Issue Slips at the HOD stage.
- Initiate your own requests (you are still an initiator in your own right).
- See department-level spend summaries.

1.2 What you cannot do

- You cannot approve things from other departments you do not head.
- You cannot approve your own initiated request — a peer HOD or higher must approve.
- You cannot skip the Finance stage. Your approval passes the request *to* Finance, not around it.
- You cannot modify amounts or items on a request you're reviewing. If something is wrong, reject with a clear comment.

1.3 Your responsibilities

1. Check requests are **legitimate business needs** for your department.
2. Check prices and quantities are **reasonable**.
3. Check the **justification makes sense**.
4. Check the request is going to the **right cost centre** (department).
5. Respond within a **reasonable time** (typically 24–48 working hours) so requests don't stall.

2. Quick Reference Card

One-page cheat sheet

To approve PRs / forms: Sidebar → Procurement → Pending Approvals, or Financial Forms → Pending Approvals.

To approve Issue Slips: Sidebar → Stores → Issue Slips. Filter by status `pending_hod`.

Click a row to open full detail.

Add a comment before clicking Approve or Reject. Comments are permanent.

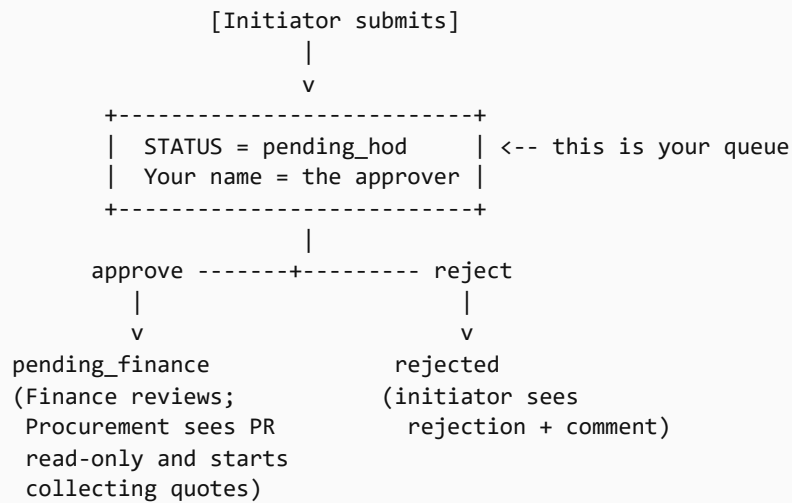
What to check before approving

1. Is this a real business need for the department?
2. Are quantities and prices sensible?
3. Is there a supplier quote attached for higher-value items?
4. Does the justification answer "why now"?
5. Does it stay within the department budget you're familiar with?

What to do when you're unavailable

- Tell Admin before you go on leave. They can temporarily reassign your pending items to another HOD or Finance.

3. Approval Workflow from Your Point of View



3.1 Time-to-approve expectations

There is no enforced deadline, but requests left at **pending_hod** for more than a few working days raise questions in the monthly report. Aim to act within 48 hours.

3.2 What happens after you approve

- Status changes to **pending_finance**.
- Finance team receives an email notification.
- For Purchase Requisitions, Procurement immediately gains read-only visibility in their **Incoming PRs** view — they can begin contacting suppliers and preparing quotes while Finance reviews.
- You can still see the request in "Approved Requisitions" for audit purposes.

3.3 What happens after you reject

- Status becomes **rejected**.
- Your comment is sent to the initiator by email.
- The initiator must create a new request to resubmit.

4. What Your Sidebar Looks Like

DASHBOARD

Home

PROCUREMENT

My Requisitions

Create Requisition

Pending Approvals

Approved Requisitions

FINANCIAL FORMS

Expense Claims

EFT Requisitions

Petty Cash

Pending Approvals

STORES

Goods Receipt Notes

Real-Time Stock Register

Stock Items

Issue Slips

Picking Slips

REPORTS & ANALYTICS

Reports

NOTE

The two "Pending Approvals" items are where you do most of your work. Your dashboard also shows a count of items waiting for you.

5. Task 1 — Find Requests Waiting for You

5.1 Check the dashboard first

- 1 On the Dashboard, look for the card titled **Pending Approvals** or **Waiting for You**.
- 2 The number on that card is the total count of items needing your action across all form types.
- 3 Click the card to open the combined approvals list.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

HOD dashboard showing a "Pending Approvals" card with count.

5.2 Procurement approvals (Purchase Requisitions)

- 1 Sidebar → **Procurement** → **Pending Approvals**.
- 2 The list shows only PRs from your department or your subordinates at status **pending_hod**.
- 3 Each row shows the ID, initiator name, total amount, and submission date.

5.3 Financial Forms approvals (EFT, PC, EC)

- 1 Sidebar → **Financial Forms** → **Pending Approvals**.
- 2 The list combines EFT Requisitions, Petty Cash, and Expense Claims.
- 3 Use the filter at the top to narrow by form type if needed.

5.4 Stores approvals (Issue Slips)

- 1 Sidebar → **Stores** → **Issue Slips**.
- 2 Filter by status **pending_hod**.
- 3 Only Issue Slips originating in your department appear at the HOD stage.

6. Task 2 — Review a Request

6.1 Open the detail view

- 1 Click any row in the Pending Approvals list.
- 2 The full detail page opens showing the form header, items, attachments, and approval history.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Requisition detail page with header, items, attached quote, and approval history section.

6.2 Check the header

- 1 **Initiator** — is this person really in your department or a subordinate?
- 2 **Date submitted** — if recent, the request is fresh; if old, it may be stale.
- 3 **Required Date** — is there enough time to process before the deadline?
- 4 **Delivery Location** — does it match the business need?

6.3 Check each item line

- 1 Does each item name make sense for your department's work?
- 2 Is the quantity reasonable? (A PR for 500 printers in a 10-person team is suspicious.)
- 3 Is the unit price sensible? Compare to what you know similar items cost.
- 4 If a quote is attached, open it and verify the supplier prices match what's in the form.

6.4 Check the justification

- 1 Scroll to the Justification text.
- 2 Does it answer: *What is this for? Why now? Why this specific item or supplier?*
- 3 If the justification is blank or vague, this is usually a reason to reject until the initiator improves it.

6.5 Check the approval history

- 1 Look for any previous approval attempts — was this request rejected before?
- 2 Read any prior comments for context.

7. Task 3 — Approve a Request

7.1 Leave a comment

- 1 Scroll to the bottom of the detail page.
- 2 Type a short comment in the **Comments** box.
- 3 Approval comments are optional but strongly encouraged — they create a clear record.
- 4 Example comments: "Approved. Quantities match stock-out projection.", "Approved. Quote from Tech Solutions is competitive.", "Approved pending Finance to check FX conversion."

7.2 Click Approve

- 1 Click the green **Approve** button.
- 2 The system records your name, role, timestamp, IP address, and browser in the audit log.
- 3 Status changes to **pending_finance** and Finance is notified by email.
- 4 You are returned to the Pending Approvals list with the request removed from your queue.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Approval action box at the bottom of a request: Comments textarea and Approve / Reject buttons.

IMPORTANT

The audit log keeps a permanent record of every approval you make, with IP address and timestamp. If a fraudulent approval is later traced to your account, it will be visible.

8. Task 4 — Reject a Request

8.1 Write a clear rejection reason

- 1 Scroll to the Comments box.
- 2 Write a specific reason so the initiator knows what to fix. Examples:
 - 3 "Quote required for purchases above K5000. Please attach and resubmit."
 - 4 "Wrong department — this should come from IT, not Operations."
 - 5 "Quantity 50 seems excessive for a 10-person team. Please justify or reduce."
- 6 Avoid vague reasons like "unclear" or "not approved" — the initiator can't fix those.

8.2 Click Reject

- 1 Click the red **Reject** button.
- 2 Status changes to **rejected**.
- 3 Initiator receives an email with your comment.
- 4 They must create a new request — they cannot edit this one.

NOTE

You and the initiator can talk informally before rejecting. Often a quick conversation fixes the issue faster than a formal rejection. Reject only when they've had a chance to correct.

9. Task 5 — Approve an Issue Slip

Issue Slips are the stock-equivalent of a PR — they require HOD approval to release goods from the warehouse.

9.1 Find pending Issue Slips

- 1 Sidebar → **Stores** → **Issue Slips**.
- 2 Filter by status **pending_hod**.

9.2 Open and review

- 1 Click a row.
- 2 Check the **Issued To** and **Delivery Location** are correct.
- 3 Check the items and quantities against the need of the receiving site.
- 4 If the Issue Slip is drawing from a specific **GRN reference**, verify there is enough stock (the system will block over-issues automatically but it's good to double-check).
- 5 Check the **Customer** field if the stock is customer-reserved.

9.3 Approve or reject

- 1 Type a comment.
- 2 Click **Approve** — status goes to **pending_finance**.
- 3 Or click **Reject** — status goes to **rejected** and the stock stays in the warehouse.

10. Task 6 — Monitor Your Department

10.1 Open Reports

- 1 Sidebar → **Reports & Analytics** → **Reports**.
- 2 Choose a date range: Today, Last 7 Days, Last 30 Days, This Month, Last Month, This Year, or All Time.

10.2 Read the summary

- 1 Total requests per status: Approved, Pending, Rejected.
- 2 Average days to approve (your turnaround).
- 3 Department totals (your department plus others if you have wider view).

10.3 Export to Excel or PDF

- 1 Click **Export to Excel** or **Download PDF** at the top of the report.
- 2 Use these in your monthly department review.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Reports page showing summary counts and a Department Spend bar chart.

11. Task 7 — Initiate Your Own Requests

You are still an initiator in your own right. The procedure is identical to what other staff do. See the **Initiator manual (01-initiator.pdf)** for the full steps.

IMPORTANT

You cannot approve a request you initiated yourself. It will automatically be routed to a peer HOD or upward to Finance for the first stage.

12. Troubleshooting

12.1 "Pending Approvals" list is empty but I know there are requests

1. Check you're looking at the right list — Procurement and Financial Forms have separate queues.
2. Refresh the page.
3. Check the filter is not limiting results to a small date range.
4. If still empty, ask Admin whether you are correctly set as HOD on your user profile.

12.2 The Approve button is greyed out

1. You may have missed the mandatory Comments field — some installations require it.
2. You may be viewing a request that is no longer at `pending_hod` — refresh and check the status.
3. The initiator may be you — you can't approve your own.

12.3 An approved request seems to be lost

1. Check **Approved Requisitions**. HOD-approved requests disappear from your Pending list but stay visible under Approved.
2. Check Finance has seen it — they may have already acted.

12.4 I'll be on leave — what happens to my queue?

1. Tell your Administrator before you go.
2. Admin can temporarily reassign your pending items to another HOD or escalate them directly to Finance.
3. Nothing is lost — items stay in the system.

12.5 I rejected by mistake

1. Ask the initiator to create a new request referencing the rejected one.
2. Approve the new one promptly with a comment explaining the original rejection was an error.
3. The audit log preserves both actions.

13. Appendix

13.1 Status values you act on

Status	Your action
pending_hod	Review and Approve / Reject
pending_finance	Wait — Finance's turn
pending_md	Wait — MD's turn (PRs only)
approved	View for reference
rejected	View for reference

13.2 Typical turnaround targets

Form	Target
Purchase Requisition	48 hours
EFT Requisition	24 hours (often time-sensitive)
Petty Cash	Same day
Expense Claim	48 hours
Issue Slip	24 hours (goods may be needed on site)

13.3 Checklist — before approving

- Request belongs to someone in my department or my subordinate.
- Items and quantities make sense.
- Prices are reasonable.
- Justification is clear.
- Required quote is attached (if applicable).
- Department is correct.
- I have left a clear comment.